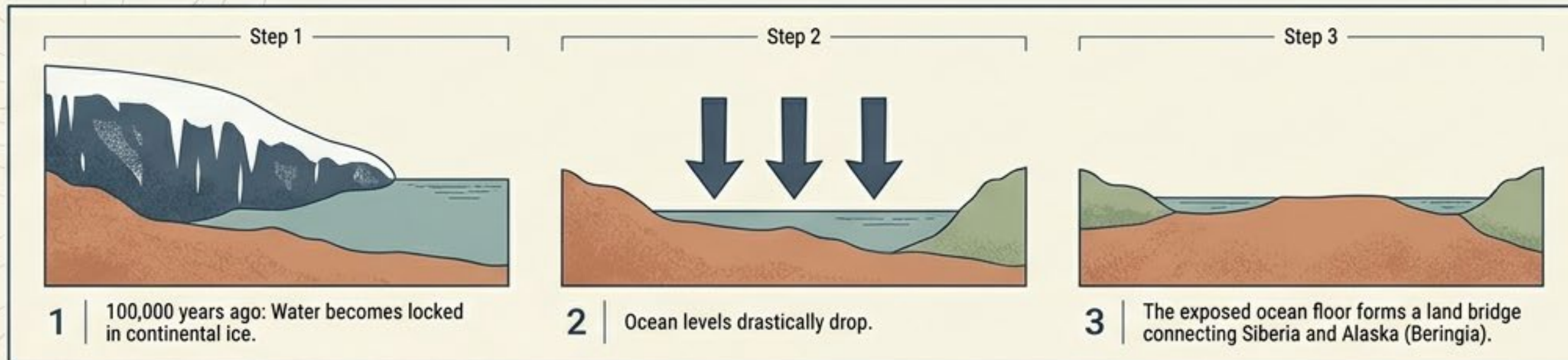
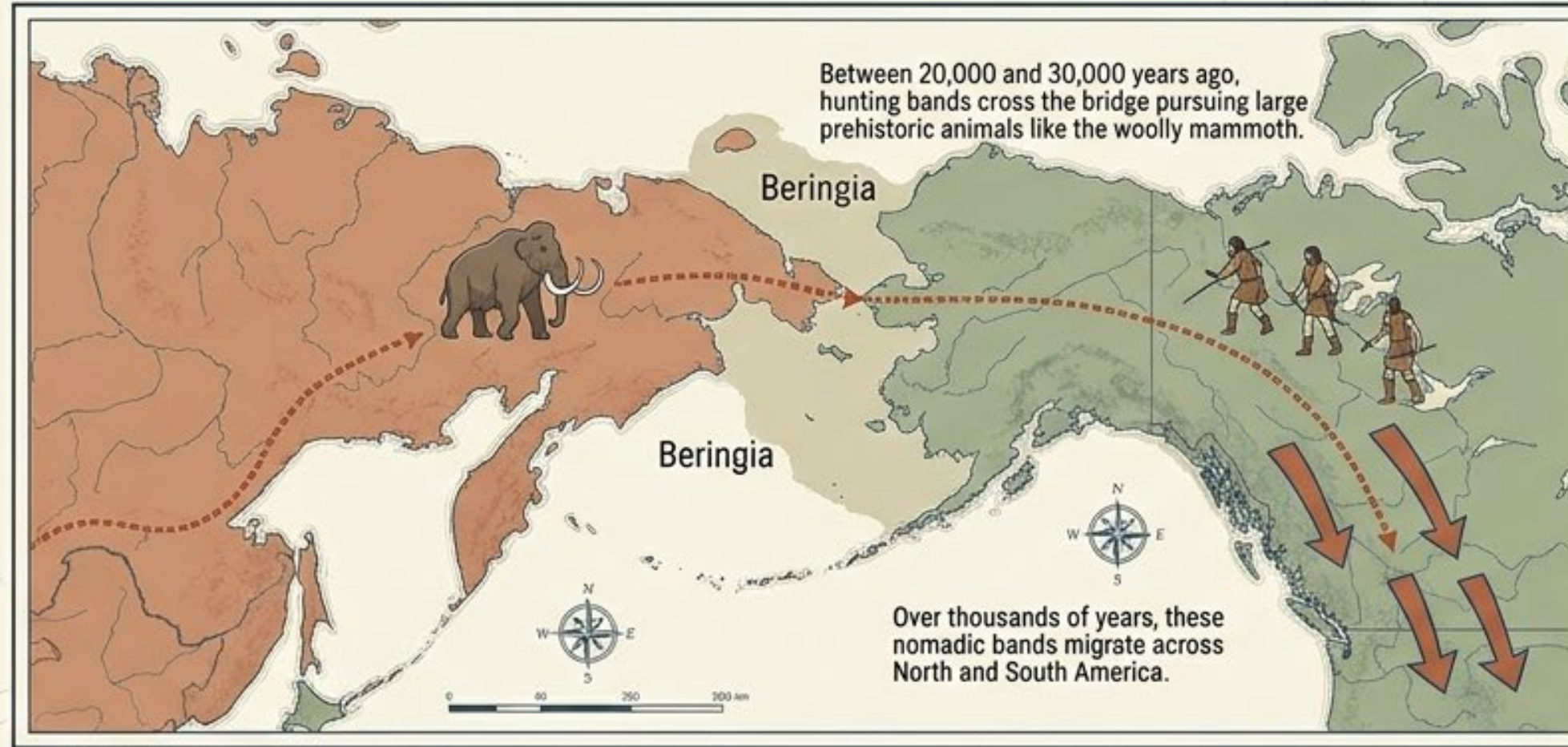


The Early Americas

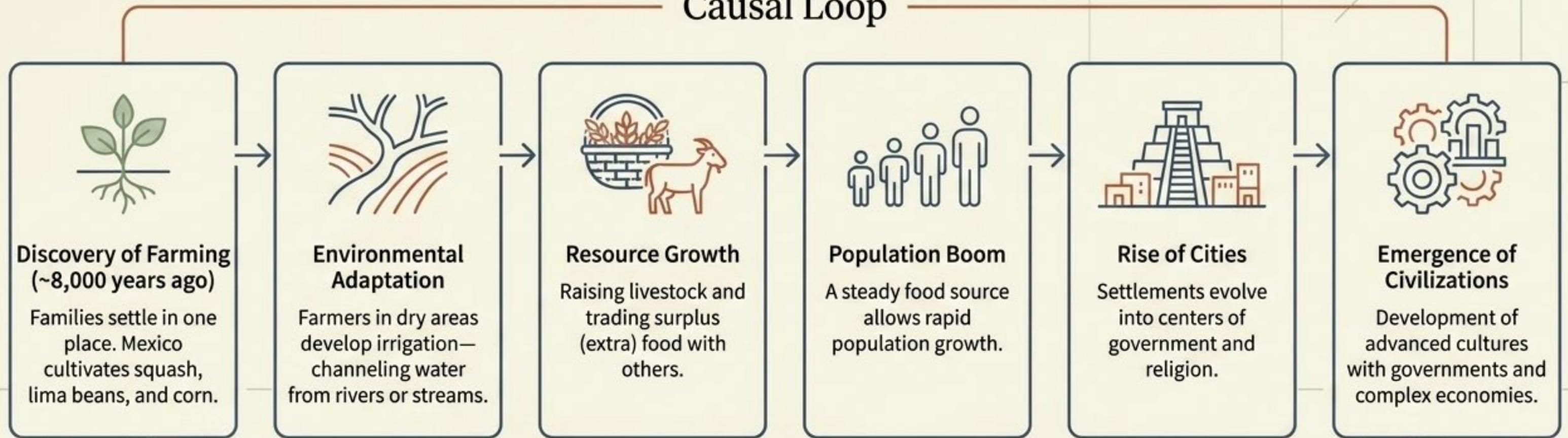
Tracing the mechanics of civilization from the Great Migration to the pre-Columbian empires.

The Ice Age Catalyst



The Agricultural Engine

Causal Loop



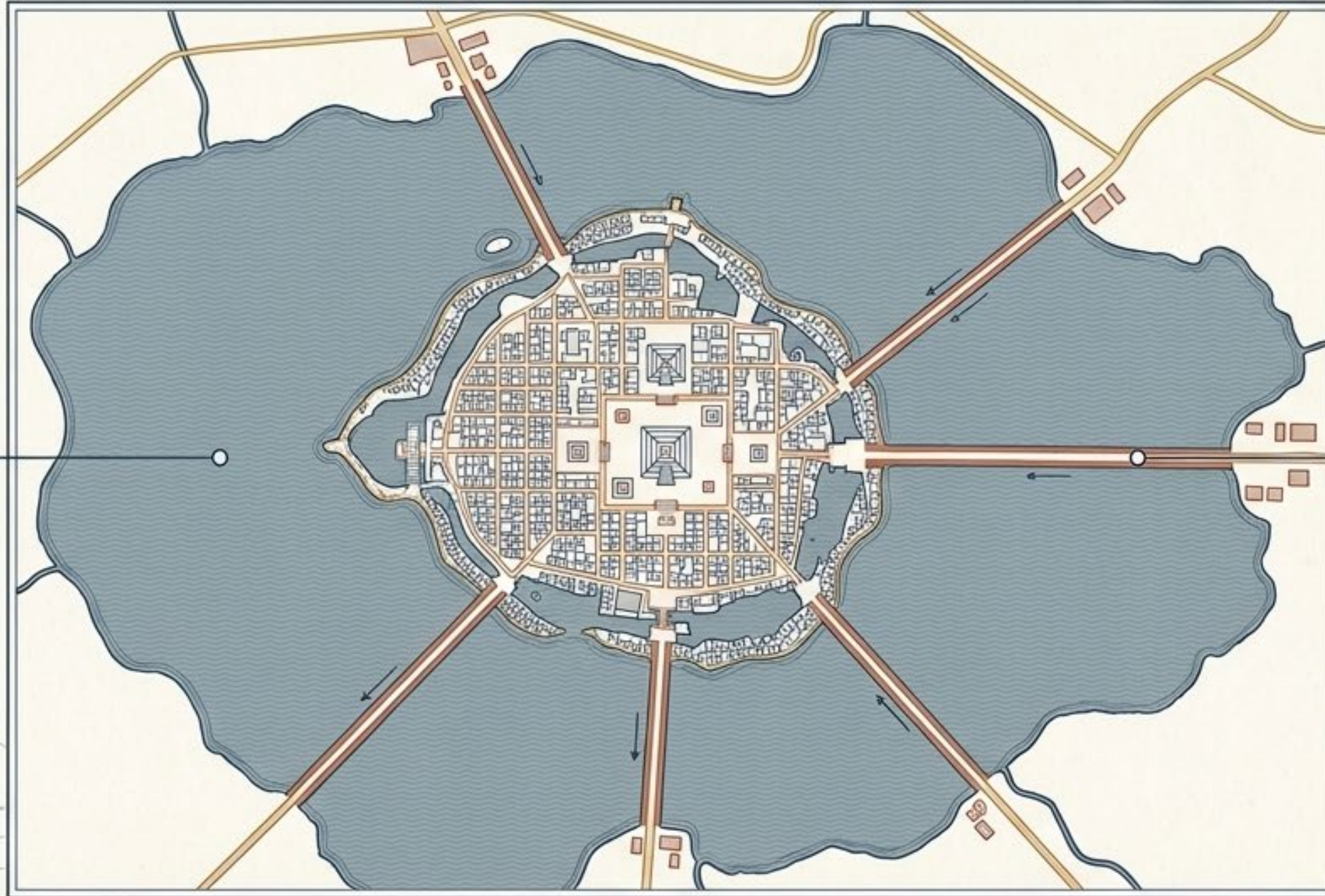
Empires of the South

The Mayas	The Aztecs	The Incas
Timeframe: A.D. 250 to A.D. 900	Timeframe: Rose to power as the Mayan civilization declined.	Timeframe: 1400s
Geography: Mexico and Central America	Geography: Central Mexico	Geography: South America
Defining Traits: Built powerful city-states centered around temples, pyramids, and palaces. Developed formal systems of government and a written language.	Defining Traits: Highly engineered island capital (Tenochtitlán) built in the middle of a large lake.	Defining Traits: A massive, multi-environment empire extending along the Andes mountains, across the Atacama Desert, and into the Amazon Rain Forest.

Engineering the Aztec Capital

1

The Lake Setting:
Built entirely on a group of islands in the middle of a large lake in central Mexico.



2

The Causeways:
Engineered causeways bridged the water, connecting the isolated urban center to the surrounding mainland.

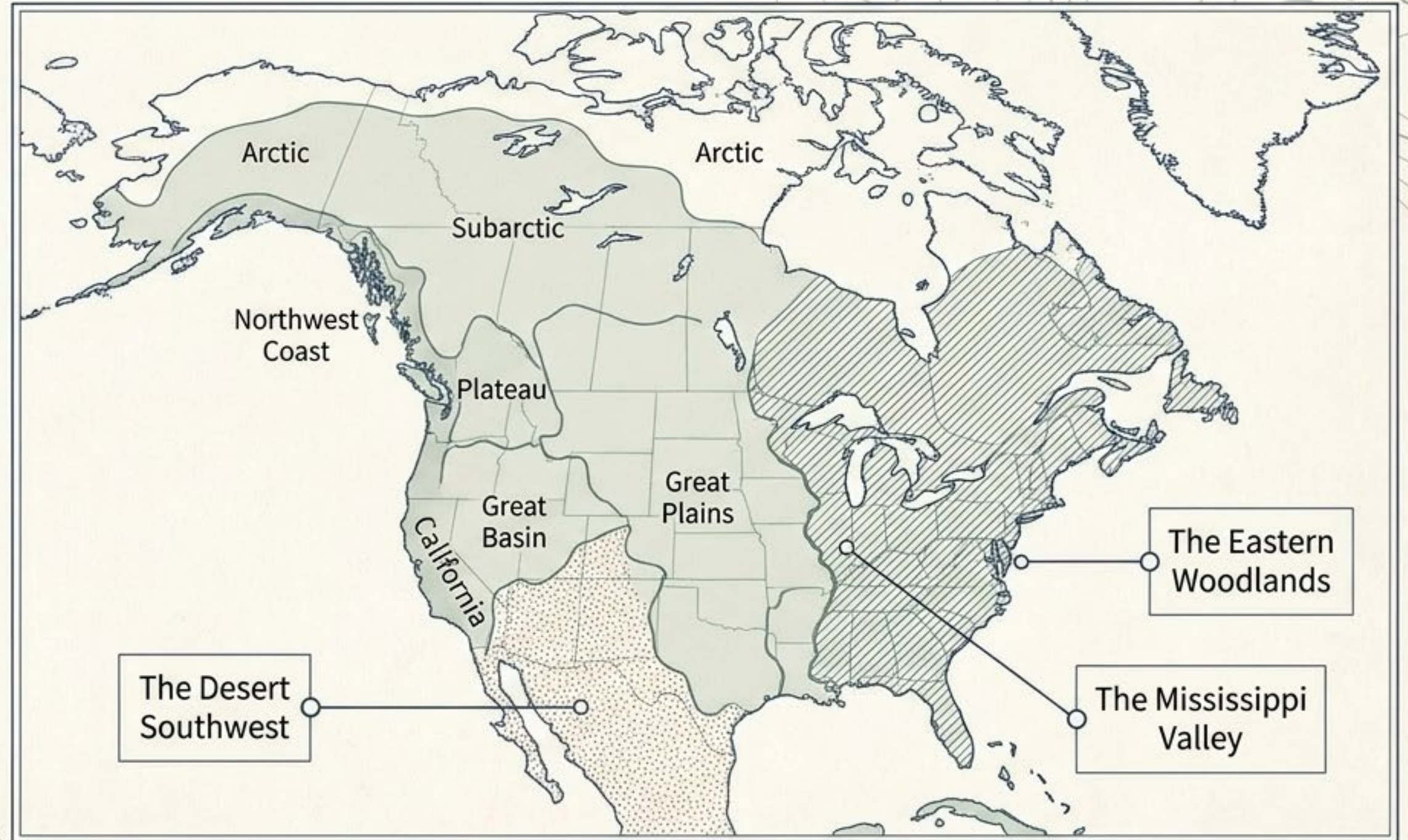
The Logic of North American “Culture Areas”

Cultures

Unique, distinct ways of life developed by different groups.

Culture Areas

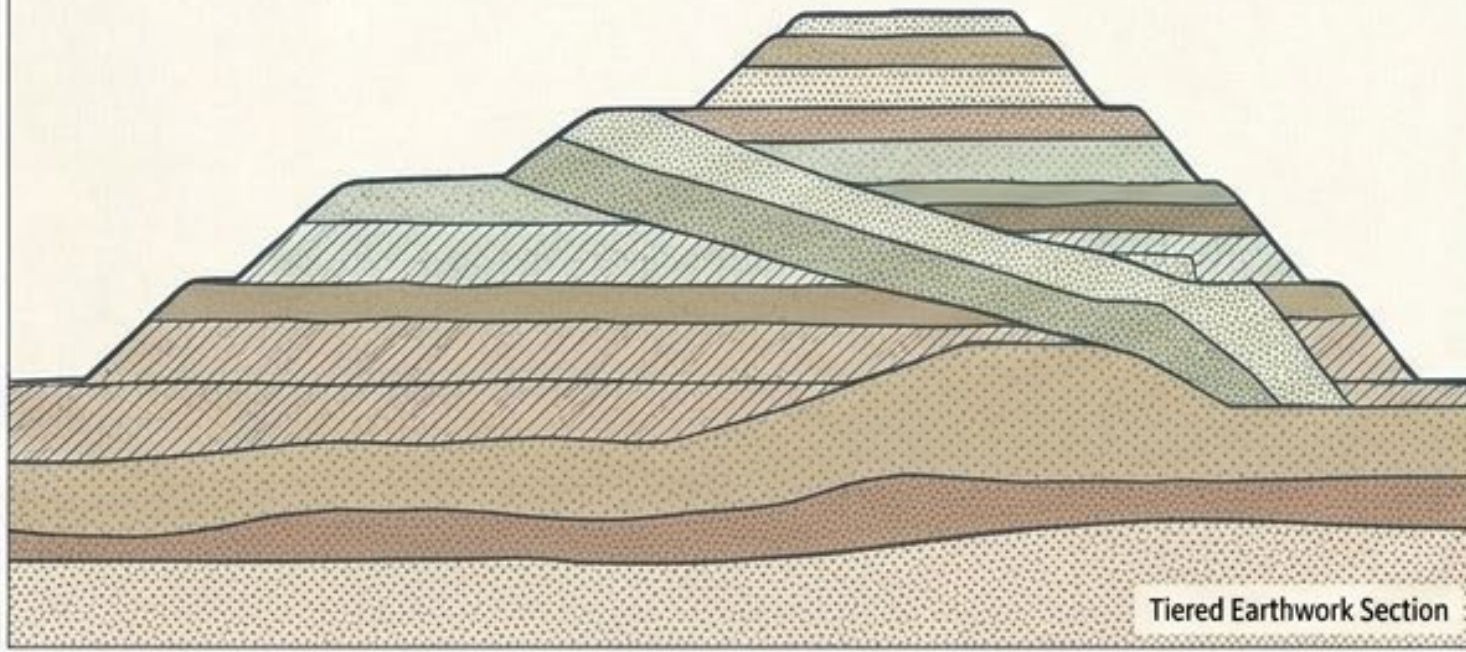
A classification used by scholars to organize regions where distinct groups of people share basic, similar traits because they are adapting to the same environmental conditions.



Masters of the Terrain

The Mound Builders

Emerged ~3,000 years ago between the Appalachian Mountains and the Mississippi Valley.



Adaptation: Moved massive amounts of earth to construct large mounds utilized as burial places and elevated platforms for public buildings.

The Anasazi

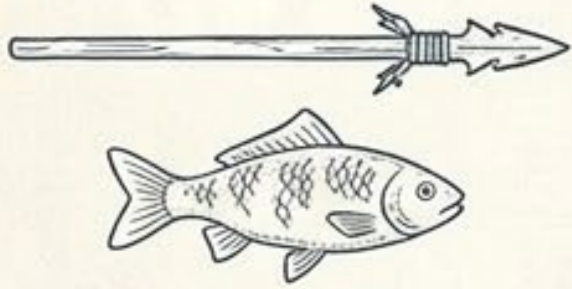
Southern Utah, Colorado, Northern Arizona, and New Mexico. (Mysteriously abandoned by 1300).



Adaptation: Mastered dry-climate architecture by building complex multilevel buildings out of adobe (dried mud). Renowned for crafting specialized baskets, pottery, and jewelry.

Life in the Eastern Woodlands

1



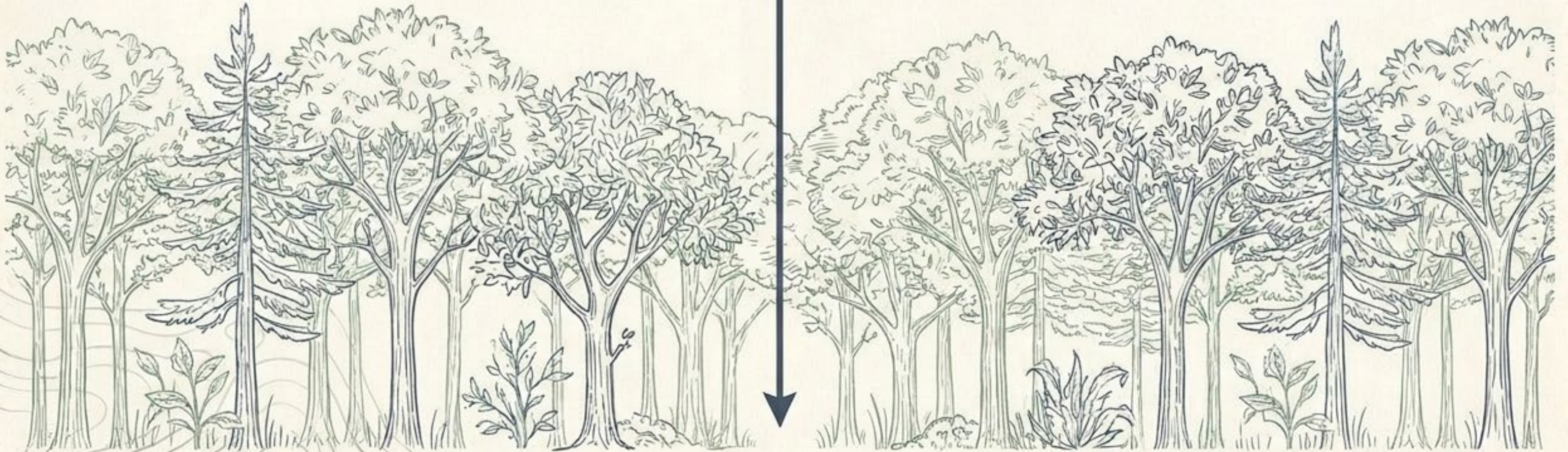
Early Survival: Early inhabitants relied entirely on hunting, fishing, and foraging for native plants within the heavy forests.

2

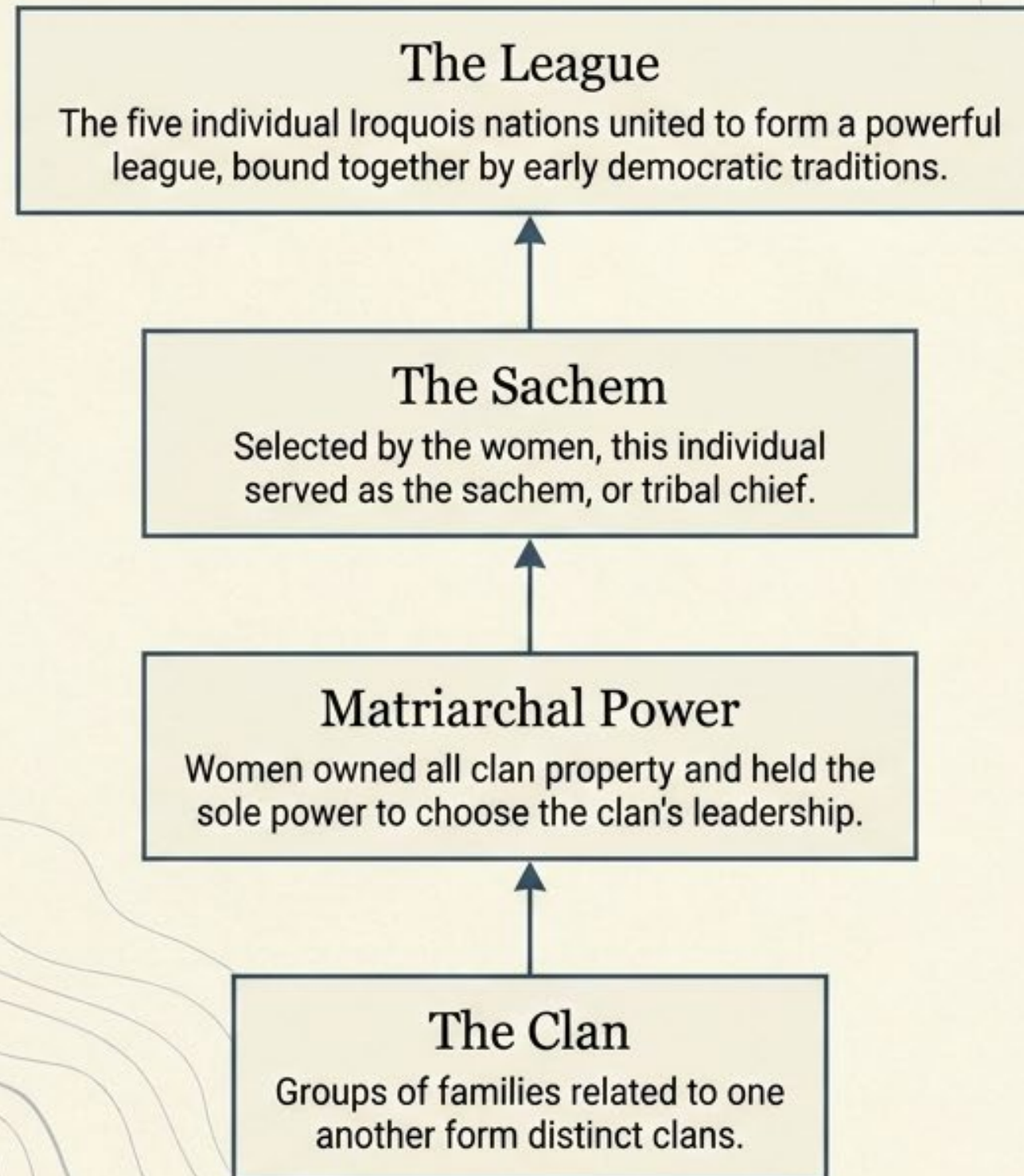
The Shift: Before A.D. 1000, Woodland societies begin adopting farming practices, ensuring stable food supplies.

3

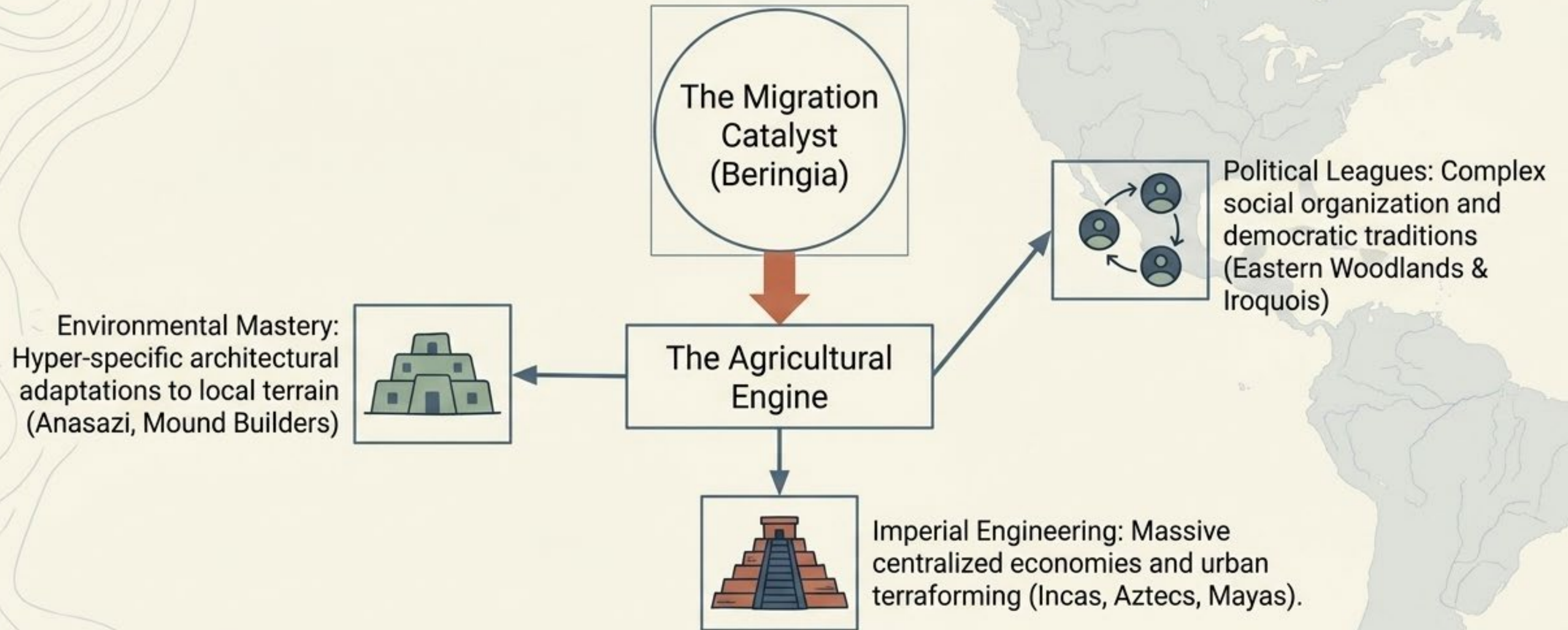
This stability in what is now New York set the geographical foundation for one of the most sophisticated political systems in the early Americas: **The Iroquois.**



The Democratic Roots of the Iroquois



The Tapestry of the Early Americas



Human ingenuity remained constant; geography dictated the form it took.